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Plumtree Court
25 Shoe Lane
London EC4A 4AU
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15th August 2026

Dear Sir/Madam,

My introduction to Goldman Sachs came not through a job posting, but through three insight events — across sales and trading, prime brokerage and the buy side. One speaker reframed how I understood the firm. Listening to Jack McFarren describe his role in UK sales as *"the conductor of the orchestra"* — pulling research, execution and the wider firm together to play the music the client wants — I arrived thinking of an investment bank as a set of separate desks, and left seeing it as a single instrument, with the client-facing seat as the point where the whole firm converges.

That integration is deliberate, not a slogan. In the buy-side session I heard how Goldman had consolidated once-competing internal teams into a single platform, so that a client meets one firm rather than many; a research analyst described the *"optionality to attack a question from many angles"* that a smaller firm simply cannot offer. Goldman's edge is the integration itself — the product is the whole platform, conducted for one client.

That is the work I want, because it is the work I have already found most rewarding. Onboarding new clients at Pictet, my role was to coordinate the strings behind a seamless arrival — compliance, relationship managers and operations — so that the client experienced one firm rather than a series of hand-offs. What stayed with me is the discipline Jack described: when a client had a query, I learned to ask what they actually wanted from the interaction, and how we could add value to what they were trying to do. Client service, I came to understand, is a discipline of the client's goals, not your pitch.

What finally convinced me the sales seat belongs at Goldman specifically was a technical point from the high-touch desk. In European equities — roughly a hundred trading venues since MiFID II, much of the screen dominated by high-frequency firms that mine order flow — a client with a large order paradoxically has to *avoid* touching the market: if buying a stock with 10% expected upside moves it 7%, only 3% of the edge survives. Preserving that spread takes bilateral liquidity, crossing natural buyers and sellers, and the firm's own balance sheet — and sourcing the borrow behind it depends on a securities-lending desk that internalises its clients' own long positions and gets the first call from the largest agent lenders, on relationships built over thirty years. That combination — research, high-touch execution, prime and stock-borrow acting as one — is not a culture a competitor can copy; it is infrastructure and relationships assembled over decades. The conductor is only as good as the orchestra behind them, and this is the one orchestra that can protect a client's alpha at the moment it is most fragile: execution.

I would value the opportunity to begin my career in that seat — at the one firm whose entire model is built to be conducted around the client. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Janak Chohan

Coach's notes (not part of the letter — delete before sending)

This is your full letter, polished in the same style and committed to the one "conductor / one instrument" idea all the way through. The final "why Goldman + why sales" paragraph is the un-replicable, technical one you asked for — here's how to use and defend it.

Why this closer is un-replicable (and why no other student will write it)

Most applicants say "Goldman has a great brand / great people." You're saying something structural: Goldman's client-facing edge is that it can **preserve a client's alpha at the point of execution** — because in fragmented European markets the act of trading destroys edge, and only a firm with the balance sheet, internalised stock-borrow, and thirty-year agent-lender relationships can protect that spread. That's not a culture a rival can copy overnight; it's infrastructure built over decades. It ties your theme shut: *the conductor is only as good as the orchestra* — so the reason to want the sales seat *is* the firm behind it.

Be ready to defend every technical claim (they will test this in interview)

- **~100 venues / MiFID II fragmentation** → why liquidity is hard to source in Europe vs the US.
- **The 10% / 7% / 3% example** (Mini's) → market impact eats expected return; large orders must minimise footprint.
- **Why avoid the screen** → HFT/systematic firms mine order flow and leak your signal, so big clients want **bilateral** liquidity (crossing natural buyers/sellers) off-screen.
- **Internalisation** → GS can re-lend its own PB clients' longs (held via swap hedges) instead of paying ~10–20bps to borrow externally — cheaper supply, better service.
- **Agent lenders** → the giant asset owners (BlackRock, State Street-type) lend the scarce borrow; GS's longevity means it gets the "first call." A "special" can cost 7–8% vs ~30–35bps for general collateral.

Only write what you can explain back. All of it is from your events, so you can.

Three things to verify before you submit

- **Names/figures:** confirm Jack McFarren's title (Head of UK Sales) and the high-touch speaker's name (Mini) — your transcript flags some as best-interpretation. It's fine to keep the high-touch point unattributed ("a technical point from the high-touch desk").
- **Pictet paragraph:** I wrote "compliance, relationship managers and operations" as the teams you coordinated in onboarding — adjust these to exactly what you did, and if you have a number (clients onboarded, time-to-onboard improvement), add it — one figure makes it concrete.
- **Length:** this runs ~430 words as a formal letter, which is fine if a role asks for an uploaded cover letter. **But Goldman's EMEA portal usually gives a ~300-word motivation box** — use the cut below there.

The ~300-word cut (for Goldman's motivation box — no address/sign-off)

> My introduction to Goldman came through three insight events — sales and trading, prime brokerage and the buy side. Listening to Jack McFarren call the salesperson "the conductor of the orchestra," pulling research, execution and the wider firm together to play the music the client wants, I stopped seeing a bank as separate desks and saw a single instrument — with the client-facing seat as the point where the whole firm converges.
>
> That integration is deliberate: Goldman consolidated once-competing teams into one platform so a client meets one firm, and a research analyst described an "optionality to attack a question from many angles" a smaller firm can't offer. The product is the whole platform, conducted for one client.
>
> It's work I've already found most rewarding: onboarding clients at Pictet, I coordinated compliance, relationship managers and operations so the client met one firm, not a series of hand-offs — learning to ask what a client actually wanted from an interaction, and how to add value to their goals rather than pitch mine.

> What convinced me the sales seat belongs at Goldman is technical: in European equities — ~100 venues since MiFID II, the screen dominated by firms that mine order flow — a large order must avoid the market; if buying a stock with 10% upside moves it 7%, only 3% survives. Protecting that spread needs bilateral liquidity, balance sheet, and a securities-lending desk that internalises its own supply and gets first call from the largest agent lenders. That combination isn't a culture a rival can copy — it's decades of infrastructure. The conductor is only as good as the orchestra, and this is the one that can protect a client's alpha where it's most fragile: execution.